

# Mid-Program Review - PMDP

Abhilash G (MS/EPA-PJ3-PS) , 26/04/2026

# Mid-Program Review - PMDP

## Participant Details

- Participant Name: Abhilash G (MS/EPA-PJ3-PS)
- Manager Name : Gunagi Ravi Raghuram (MS/EPA-PJ3-PS)
- Role: Project Manager
- Function/Department: MS/EPA
- Role : Responsible for "on time, on spec, on budget, on quality, on compliance and on resources" in the project calibration corresponding to project agreement.
- Activities involved – requirement analysis, evaluate risks and compliance, estimation & quotation, budget planning and tracking, data assessment and release, product delivery to customer etc
- Customers : Bosch Japan and OEM (Japan, Thailand, India)

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## Module-wise Learning Application

| Modules      |                                        | Been able to apply | Identified areas to apply | No Scope to apply |
|--------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------|-------------------|
| Leadership   | Leader in me                           | ✓                  |                           |                   |
|              | Resilient Leadership                   | ✓                  |                           |                   |
|              | Uncertainty Management                 | ✓                  |                           |                   |
|              | Strategic Thinking & Creativity        | ✓                  |                           |                   |
| Professional | Leading Cross-functional teams         | ✓                  |                           |                   |
|              | Negotiation Skills/Conflict Management | ✓                  |                           |                   |

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## Application of program learnings – with real example

- **Topic/Issue** : Emission Test Deviations in one of the OEM projects
  - Recent test results showed increased THC and NMHC values in the tests performed at RB-India testing facility compared to the results taken in the beginning, raising concerns about certification readiness and schedule impact for the program.
  - Measurements at RB-JP facility shows consistent emission behavior (no increase)
- **Analysis**
  - Multiple suspected factors → Calibration data, Vehicle, testing facility variations, exhaust treatment system components etc were analysed in detail
- **Root Cause**
  - Root cause identified as test fuel degradation under non-controlled storage conditions in India. In RBJP and Customer facilities, test fuel has been stored under strict temperature controlled rooms, between 5-10degC
  - Certain parameters in the fuel (DVPE, VLI) are degraded with storage under ambient temperature, and this caused the emissions to become more.

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## Application of Learnings – Resilient Leadership

### ■ Stabilizing Situation under pressure

- Fuel DVPE went out of specification and Vapor Lock Index dropped, indicating fuel storage affected emission results.
- Avoided reactive calibration changes; anchored discussion on DVPE & VLI evidence
- Periodic structured communication (facts vs assumptions) has been done to maintain team stability
- Stakeholders aligned on facts Vs hypotheses to ensure transparent, data-driven decision-making and risk management.
- Measured, Evidence-Based Response → Leadership anchored decisions on verified data to avoid premature corrective actions and unnecessary risks.
- Leadership style reduced team anxiety and fostered evidence-based problem solving during high-pressure situations
- Consistent, transparent communication preserved trust with stakeholders and ensured professional response

### ■ Outcome: Prevented vehicle behavior change risk due to any calibration update and retained stakeholder confidence

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## Application of Learnings – Uncertainty Management

### ■ Progress with Guardrails

- Root cause not fully known (storage vs vehicle-level fuel degradation)
- Structured Uncertainty Management → A clear approach separated confirmed data from uncertain areas, enabling safe continuation of testing
- Implemented containment - Fuel Monitoring Protocol → Fuel samples were tested every fifteen days for critical parameters to monitor degradation effectively
- Operational Guardrails → Rules excluded out-of-spec fuel and introduced vehicle-level precautions like temperature-controlled storage
- Enabled continued testing without compromising data integrity
- Maintaining Progress Amid Uncertainty → Defined guardrails allowed momentum and reduced uncertainty without compromising data integrity

### ■ Outcome: Reduced uncertainty without stopping program progress

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## Application of Learnings – Strategic Thinking & Creativity

- **Solving Beyond the Immediate Issue**

- Recognized fuel degradation as a systemic, repeatable risk
- Initiated feasibility for fuel storage at temperature controlled facility similar to RBJP as long-term prevention
- Interim measures like controlled vehicle soaking and fuel handling were standardized and communicated for consistency.

- **Outcome:** Shifted from short-term fix to sustainable solution

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## Application of Learnings – Leading Cross-Functional Teams

### ▪ Clear Ownership & Execution

- Coordinated Multi-Function Execution → Successful emission risk management required collaboration across diverse teams and external partners, avoiding fragmented ownership.
- Coordination needed across calibration, testing facility and infrastructure teams, RBJP and Customer
- Clear Role Alignment → Responsibilities were assigned to roles rather than individuals, ensuring accountability and continuous execution
- Documented clear 'way forward' to avoid ambiguity
- Flexible resource use and coordination across sites enabled risk mitigation while investigations continued

### ▪ Outcome: Faster execution and reduced alignment rework



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## Application of Learnings – Negotiation and Conflict Management

### ■ **Balancing Speed, Safety, and Quality**

- Managed competing interests → project timelines vs data credibility vs facility concerns.
- Risk of Project Delays → Additional validation needs threatened to delay the critical project timeline during ongoing investigations
- Shift to Alternate Facility → Selected emission tests were moved to the RBJP facility meeting key environmental and fuel storage standards This shift reduced single-site dependency, maintained data consistency, and kept project milestones on schedule
- Negotiated conditional continuation of tests at RBIN with defined safeguards
- Used fact-based framing to avoid blame and escalation
- Documented clear 'way forward' to avoid ambiguity

### ■ **Outcome:** Consensus achieved without compromising compliance and project timelines

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## Application of Learnings – Leadership

### ■ **Maturity Demonstrated**

- Stabilized Program Trajectory → Data-driven decisions and strategic countermeasures preserved emission data credibility and maintained project timelines
- Fuel Storage Risk Mitigation → Identified process vulnerabilities led to feasibility assessments for safer fuel storage at controlled temperatures
- Leadership and Communication → The experience emphasized addressing root causes, managing uncertainty, and using structured communication as leadership tools
- Project timelines safeguarded using RBJP test shift as countermeasure
- Stronger fuel-handling process established for future programs

### ■ **Outcome - Long-Term Resilience**

- Consensus achieved without compromising compliance and project timelines.
- The outcome enhanced a resilient operating model for future emission development activities and risk prevention.

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## Next 30–60 Day Leadership Actions (Training Application)

### ▪ Resilient Leadership & Uncertainty Management

- ❖ Apply explicit *known vs unknown* framing with clear decision guardrails to remain calm, structured, and effective under ambiguity

### ▪ Strategic Thinking & Creativity

- ❖ Shift daily execution from task-driven actions to outcome-based planning by evaluating multiple options and their trade-offs

### ▪ Cross-Functional Leadership, Negotiation & Conflict Management

- ❖ Improve alignment by clarifying ownership early, separating interests from positions, and closing discussions with clear written agreements

### ▪ Success will be measured by :

- Clearer and faster decision-making under uncertainty,
- More outcome-oriented planning with fewer late corrections,
- Smoother cross-functional alignment with reduced escalations and rework.

thank you

# Back up

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RE: Fuel storage topic - Honda



Abhilash G (MS/EPA-PJ3-PS)

To Prashanth Kumar K (PS/ETW1-IN); Jaishankar P (PS/ETW1-IN); Nagaprasad K (PS/ETW1-IN); Gunagi Ravi Raghuram (MS/EPA-PJ3-PS);  
 Mahendra Dheeraj Jain (MS/EAV4-PS); Mathad Vinaya Channayya (BGSJ/EEGT)  
Cc Aravind A Karalingannavar (PS/ETW-IN); Chandra Segar Prabhu (PS/ETW1-IN); Ashis Kumar Nayak (MS/EPA-PS);  
 Sudhindra C V (MS/EAV-PS); Santhosh Kumar K Somu (MS/EAV4-PS)

Summarize

Reply Reply All Forward

Tue 3/31/2026 9:35 AM

Hello All,  
Thank you for joining the discussion. Please find below the summary of the call.

## Background Information

- In the **Honda 6SAY project**, higher **THC and NMHC** levels have been observed in recent emission tests compared to the measurements conducted in **October 2025**.
- Initial root-cause analysis indicated potential **fuel quality concerns**, which have since been confirmed through fuel-sample test results. Specifically:
  - DVPE has gone out of specification** after approximately **4 months**, and
  - Vapour Lock Index (VLI)** has reduced significantly.
- Fuel storage conditions are suspected to be one of the primary contributors to this fuel degradation. However, as the current sample was taken from a **vehicle**, further confirmation is required through **testing of samples collected directly from storage/barrel**.
- At both **Honda** and **RBJP** locations, fuel is stored under **temperature-controlled conditions** in line with **Honda requirements**.

## Way Forward / Agreed Actions

- RBIN-ETW** will initiate the feasibility assessment for establishing **fuel storage at 15°C**. As this involves fuel storage, **safety approvals will be critical** before implementation – discussions initiated with the concerned teams
- Until the proposed storage facility becomes operational:
  - Fuel samples will be tested **every 15 days** for critical parameters such as **DVPE, VLI**, etc. At the end of 2 months, all parameters will be tested
  - Test results will be **shared with all stakeholders**.
  - Fuel found **out of specification will not be used** for any testing activities.
- For test vehicles:
  - Only the **minimum required quantity of fuel** will be filled prior to tests.
  - Vehicles will be parked in a **soaking room (not outdoors)** to ensure the fuel remains at a lower temperature within the vehicle. (aprox 20 degC)

Please let us know if any clarification is required or if additional inputs are needed.

Best regards,

Abhilash G

MS/EPA (MS/EPA-PJ3-PS)

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